

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Development and Social Progress - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

RAPID REVISION 1 - Growth, Development and Progress - the Core Distinction

Recap in five keystrokes

- Three rungs: **GROWTH (output) -> DEVELOPMENT (structural + human) -> PROGRESS (justified value)**.
- Growth is a **possible means**, not the end; averages hide distribution.
- Economistic model = the **category slide** that treats rung 1 as rung 3.
- Two gaps break the slide: **distribution gap** and **conversion gap**.
- Master thesis is **analytical synthesis (ANALYSIS:)**, not a quotation.

MEMORY: Mnemonic: **G-D-P is not GDP** - Growth, Development, Progress are three rungs, not one number.

Trap: writing "development = progress" loses the value-level distinction and caps your score. Always name the normative test.

Retrieve now: MCQs 1-4 (this subtopic) and Remedial MCQ 41 (growth != progress).

RAPID REVISION 2 - Human Development and the Capability Approach - Sen, Nussbaum, Haq

Recap in five keystrokes

- Question shift: from "how rich?" to "**what can this person be and do?**"
- Chain: **RESOURCE -> CONVERSION -> FUNCTIONING -> CAPABILITY -> AGENCY**.
- **Conversion factors** => equal income, unequal freedom.
- **Adaptive preferences** => contentment can mask deprivation.
- **Sen (open list) vs Nussbaum (threshold list)**; Haq/UNDP = human development.

MEMORY: Mnemonic: **R-C-F-C-A** - "Resources Convert to Functionings; Capabilities Anchor agency."

Trap: describing capability as "income plus welfare schemes" collapses the whole approach back into resources. Keep *real freedom* central.

Retrieve now: MCQs 5-8 (this subtopic) and Remedial MCQ 42 (Sen != income + welfare).

RAPID REVISION 3 - Dependency, Post-Development and Sustainable Development

Recap in five keystrokes

- **Dependency** = power/terms of trade (centre-periphery), not just internal lag.
- **Post-development** = "development" as a discourse that can erase other lives.
- **Sustainable development** = keep improving lives *within ecological + future limits*.
- Weak vs strong sustainability = **substitutable vs non-substitutable** natural capital.
- The **development-vs-environment dichotomy is false**: ask *which* development, *how shared*, *within what limits*.

MEMORY: Mnemonic: **WHOM . TERMS . LIMITS** - dependency (whom/terms), post-dev (whose terms), sustainability (what limits).

Trap: using post-development to *romanticise* poverty. The poor demand capabilities too; the critique targets imposed models, not health and schooling.

Retrieve now: MCQs 9-12 (this subtopic) and Remedial MCQ 43 (an index/model is not complete).

RAPID REVISION 4 - Social Progress - Is It Inevitable?

Recap in five keystrokes

- Progress is **normative** (a value judgement), not a bare fact of change.
- It is **multidimensional**: gains on one axis can hide losses on another.
- **Not inevitable** - reject the linear "law of history" picture.
- Three replies to inevitability: **cyclical/tragic, pluralist, postcolonial**.
- Every progress claim is **criterion-relative and must be defended**.

MEMORY: Mnemonic: **C-P-P** against inevitability - Cyclical, Pluralist, Postcolonial.

Trap: treating "it changed / it grew" as "it progressed." Always name the value criterion and check for offsetting losses.

Retrieve now: MCQs 13-16 (this subtopic) and Remedial MCQ 44 (technology != ethical progress).

RAPID REVISION 5 - Criteria, Necessary/Sufficient, Recognition and Democracy

Recap in five keystrokes

- Criteria are **plural and can conflict** (liberty vs equality, etc.).
- Injustice = goods **and** status: **redistribution + recognition**, not one alone.
- Democracy is **instrumental and constitutive**; authoritarian-development has a human cost.
- Economic development: **necessary enabler, not sufficient** guarantee.
- 2024 nuance: **neither strictly necessary in every case nor ever sufficient**.

MEMORY: Mnemonic: **N-not-S** - "Necessary enabler, never Sufficient."

Trap: answering 2024 with a flat "necessary but not sufficient" and skipping the material-threshold/both-neither nuance loses the 5-mark judgement split.

Retrieve now: MCQs 17-20 (this subtopic) and Remedial MCQ 45 (necessary vs sufficient handled precisely).

RAPID REVISION 6 - Technology, Ethics and Skill Education

Recap in five keystrokes

- Technology = **power-multiplier**, not a value; it is **not self-justifying**.
- It **changes the ethical terrain**; it does not raise ethical standards on its own (2019).
- New powers = new harms: **displacement, surveillance, digital divide, algorithmic power, ecological cost**.
- Skill education **enhances development conditionally** (2023) - employability != capability.
- Governing **ends + institutions** decide whether power becomes progress.

MEMORY: Mnemonic: **POWER != GOOD** - technology amplifies power; ethics decides good.

Trap: answering 2019 with a one-sided "yes, technology improves ethics." It expands *capacity*, not *morality*; name the new harms.

Retrieve now: MCQs 21-24 (this subtopic) and Remedial MCQ 46 (necessary vs sufficient reinforcement / tech-ethics).

RAPID REVISION 7 - Gandhian Social Development

Recap in five keystrokes

- Hub = **sarvodaya** (uplift of all, test by the last person).
- Spokes = **swaraj, trusteeship, restraint of wants, dignity of labour, decentralisation.**
- Metric is **moral/relational** (needs not greed), not output volume.
- **Means-ends unity**: good ends need good means.
- Decisive internal objection = **Ambedkar on caste/gender in the village.**

MEMORY: Mnemonic: **S-S-T-R-D** - Sarvodaya, Swaraj, Trusteeship, Restraint, Dignity of labour.

Trap: presenting Gandhi as pure nostalgia and omitting the Ambedkar caste critique - or omitting the reply that his target is consumerism, not schooling and health.

Retrieve now: MCQs 25-28 (this subtopic) and Remedial MCQ 47 (do not romanticise the village).

RAPID REVISION 8 - Development and Tribal Values - the Reconciliation Model

Recap in five keystrokes

- Extraction-development imposes **displacement, ecological loss, assimilation**; benefits flow out.
- Four tests: **CAPABILITY . PARTICIPATION . IRREVERSIBILITY . BURDEN.**
- Reconciliation changes **decision-power**, not just compensation.
- Indian legal facts: **PESA 1996, FRA 2006, Orissa Mining 2013, Arts 48A & 51A(g)** - law, not proof.
- Avoid both **romanticising** and **steamrolling** tribal communities.

MEMORY: Mnemonic: **C-P-I-B** - Capability, Participation, Irreversibility, Burden.

Trap: citing PESA/FRA/2013 as if they *prove* the philosophical thesis. They are legal recognition; the argument still needs the four tests.

Retrieve now: MCQs 29-32 (this subtopic) and Remedial MCQ 48 (statute != philosophical proof).

RAPID REVISION 9 - Ecological Political Philosophy and the Limits of Development

Recap in five keystrokes

- Triangle corners: **ecological limit . intergenerational justice . distributive justice now.**
- Standing spectrum: **anthropocentric -> biocentric -> ecocentric**; **Naess 1973** shallow vs deep.
- Growth debate: **productivism vs sufficiency/degrowth**; blanket degrowth is **asymmetric for India.**
- **Non-identity problem** => impersonal duties + precaution; **strong sustainability** => non-substitutable nature.
- Risk **eco-authoritarianism** -> reply **just transition**; **environmentalism of the poor** (Guha, Martinez-Alier 1997).

MEMORY: Mnemonic: **LIMIT + 2 JUSTICES** - stay within limits, be fair to the future AND the poor now.

Trap: prescribing blanket degrowth for India, or citing 48A/51A(g) as enforceable. Couple sufficiency with base capability; the Articles are non-justiciable.

Retrieve now: MCQs 33-36 (this subtopic) and Remedial MCQ 41 (growth != progress reinforcement / ecological cost).

RAPID REVISION 10 - Inter-School Debates, Criticisms and Common Traps

Recap in five keystrokes

- Five debates: **growth/Sen . Sen/Nussbaum . Gandhi/modernisation . Gandhi/Ambedkar . modernisation/post-dev.**
- Compare models by **end, agent, institutions, nature, key danger** (the matrix).
- Universal spine: **DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> LADDER/CAPABILITY -> MODEL CONTRAST -> LIMIT+JUSTICE -> OBJECTION/REPLY -> VERDICT.**
- Ten traps = the examiner's failure modes; avoid them explicitly.
- Ownership discipline: **route caste to Caste Discrimination, ideology labels to Political Ideologies.**

MEMORY: Mnemonic: **MATRIX + SPINE** - compare with the matrix, structure with the spine.

Trap: dismissing a rival model in one line. Stage the disagreement and say what survives - that is where 20-mark answers separate.

Retrieve now: MCQs 37-40 (this subtopic) and Remedial MCQs 41-48 (full remedial sweep).

CANONICAL EXAM APPARATUS (PRESERVED VERBATIM)

The examiner apparatus below is reproduced verbatim from the canonical Development-Social-Progress.md (headings demoted, navigation links stripped). It is preserved intact so that no canonical depth - the keyword and statement bank with its corpus-driven depth delta, the PYQ routing table for 2018-2025, the answer architecture with its directive decoder, the selectable evidence bank (D1-D15) with each unit's stated limitation and the graded verdict formulas, the link-outs and the sources - is lost in the layered reorganisation.

Keyword and Statement Bank (with Corpus-Driven Depth Delta)

9.1 Keywords

Promoted vocabulary (this pass) ANALYSIS:: anthropocentric · biocentric · ecocentric · moral considerability · shallow ecology · deep ecology · productivism · degrowth · throughput · sufficiency · contraction and convergence · subsistence vs luxury consumption · intergenerational justice · non-identity problem · pure time preference · precaution and irreversibility · environmentalism of the poor · ecological distribution conflict · eco-authoritarianism · just transition

growth · structural transformation · human development · functioning · capability · conversion factors · agency · adaptive preferences · social progress · intergenerational justice · sustainability · participation · recognition · dependency · post-development · *sarvodaya* · *swarāj* · trusteeship · dignity of labour

9.2 Reusable statement lines

- FACT: Income is a means of development; capability is a measure of what the means enable.
- ANALYSIS: Growth becomes progress only through just conversion into freedom, dignity and sustainable institutions.
- FACT: Development treats persons inadequately when it counts them as beneficiaries but not agents.
- ANALYSIS: Technology expands power; ethics and institutions determine whether that power is progressive.
- ANALYSIS: Participation is both instrumentally useful and constitutive of development.
- FACT: Social progress is normative and multidimensional; it is not an automatic law of history.
- ANALYSIS: Development compatible with tribal dignity must alter not only compensation but decision-power.

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (expanded PYQ audit)

- ANALYSIS: **Priority:** Primary ownership is 6 of 112 parts; no owned question appears in 2018 or 2021.
- FACT: **Required doctrinal depth:** The older corpus adds technology versus ethical progress and Gandhian social development, while later papers test economic/human/social development, skill education and tribal values.
- WRONG: **Trap / answer consequence:** Do not equate growth, development and progress; specify metric, necessary/sufficient relation, distribution, agency, culture and moral costs.

PYQ Routing Table (2018-2025)

ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** 6 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper II corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2019	Q2(c)	15	Does technological development lead to progress in the ethical standards of the society? Explain.
2020	Q2(a)	20	State and examine the Gandhian concept of social development.
2022	Q3(a)	20	Do you agree that economic development does not on its own lead to human development and social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.
2023	Q2(c)	15	In the present scenario, will the emphasis on skill education enhance development? Evaluate.
2024	Q3(c)	10+5=15	Is economic development a necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither, in order to achieve social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.
2025	Q3(c)	15	Is it possible to reconcile the concept of development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress? Discuss.

See the Socio-Political PYQ Bank, 2018-2025.

Answer Architecture (10 / 15 / 20 Marks)

11.0 Directive decoder - the verb fixes the structure

Directive in the stem	What is actually scored	Compulsory structural move	Failure mode
Explain	internal logic of one conception	definition -> components -> distinction from the neighbouring term -> example	listing indicators instead of stating a conception
Discuss	exposition plus one adjudicated tension	conception -> rival -> objection -> reply -> verdict	describing schemes and statistics
Evaluate	a judgment against a stated standard	name the standard -> apply -> concede the counter-case -> verdict	balanced description with no standard
Is X a necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither?	the modal terms must be handled separately and explicitly	test necessity -> test sufficiency -> state which holds and why -> verdict	answering "it is important"
Do you agree that...	commitment is compulsory, with reasons and justification as asked	qualified position at the outset -> reasons -> counter-case -> restated position	a survey of both sides
Is it possible to reconcile X with Y?	conditions of reconciliation, not a yes/no	state what each requires -> identify the collision -> specify the conditions under which both are satisfiable	a wish-list of "balanced development"
Does X lead to Y?	a causal claim requires a mechanism and a defeater	mechanism -> what could break it -> verdict on the conditional	assertion of correlation

11.1 10-mark method (~150 words · 4 moves · ~12 minutes)

1. **Distinguish the paired terms (2 lines)** using the §1.2 grid - growth, economic development, human development, capability, social progress are five different concepts with five different measures.
2. **One causal or normative relation (4-5 lines)**, stated as a mechanism with its conversion conditions.
3. **One failure mode plus one evidence unit** from §11.4, with its limitation.
4. **Graded verdict (2 lines)** - necessary, sufficient, conditional or neither, answered in those terms.

WRONG: At 10 marks do not attempt Sen, Nussbaum, Gandhi and ecology together. One relation, fully worked.

11.2 15-mark method (~220 words · 6 moves · ~18 minutes)

1. **State which conception of development is under dispute** - the answer differs sharply depending on whether the stem assumes the economistic, human-development or capability conception.
2. **Exposition** of that conception with its presupposition.
3. **The question-specific issue** - skill, technology, tribe, ecology - worked through the conception, not appended to it.
4. **One table**: the concept grid (§1.2), Sen's terms (§1.5), the three ecological orientations (§5A.1) or the §5A.7 binding grid.
5. **One fully worked objection** -> **reply** -> **residual problem**: paternalism, distribution, ecology, participation or adaptive preference.
6. **Explicit graded judgment** in the stem's own modal vocabulary.

ANALYSIS: For necessary/sufficient stems, run the two tests separately and name the counter-case for each: growth without capability expansion defeats sufficiency; severe material deprivation blocking health, education and voice supports a threshold form of necessity. State the threshold qualification - that is where the marks are.

11.3 20-mark method (~300 words · 8 moves · ~25 minutes)

1. **Provisional thesis**: development is a contested normative concept, and the stem turns on which conception is assumed.
2. **The sequence**: economistic -> human development -> capability -> social progress, showing what each conception *adds* and what defect it corrects.
3. **The strongest rival model** - dependency, post-development, Gandhian or ecological - in its best form.
4. **Two objection** -> **reply chains**, each ending in a residual problem.
5. **The ecological layer** (§5A) where the stem concerns sustainability, tribal communities or the limits of growth: orientation -> productivism critique -> intergenerational duty -> environmentalism of the poor.
6. **The distributive reframing**: who defines benefit, who bears cost, who decides - this converts a description into an argument.
7. **One dated Indian illustration**, classified accurately as statute, judgment or constitutional provision, with the reminder that non-justiciable provisions establish commitment and not outcome.
8. **Graded verdict** separating means, conversion conditions and final values.

ANALYSIS: On tribal-development stems, the mark-bearing structure is the four-test conclusion at §5A.7: capabilities destroyed as well as gained; participation in the decision and not only in compensation; a precautionary presumption against irreversible loss; and no shifting of adjustment costs onto those least able to bear them.

11.4 Selectable evidence bank - 1 unit at 10 marks, 2 at 15, 4-5 at 20

Each unit is **Claim** -> **Named anchor** -> **Use for** -> **Limitation**.

- **D1 · Growth is a means whose value depends on conversion**. Claim: income matters through what it enables persons to be and do, and conversion varies with body, environment and social norms -> Named: Sen, *Development as Freedom* -> Use for: every development stem -> Limit: measurement and the selection of relevant capabilities remain contested.
- **D2 · Utility adapts downward under deprivation**. Claim: the long-deprived may report satisfaction, so subjective welfare is an unreliable metric of development -> Named: Sen's adaptive preferences -> Use for: the decisive objection to welfare-based and satisfaction-based measures -> Limit: risks paternalism if the analyst overrides reported preference without argument.
- **D3 · Justice requires a threshold of central capabilities**. Claim: each person must reach a threshold compatible with dignity, specified as a political-constitutional minimum -> Named: Nussbaum, *Creating Capabilities* -> Use for: rights-adjacent development stems -> Limit: a fixed list invites the charge of imposing one conception of the good; capability protects opportunity, not compulsory functioning.
- **D4 · Human development is not income**. Claim: longevity, knowledge and a decent standard displace output as the measure -> Named: Mahbub ul Haq; the UNDP framework -> Use for: 10-mark distinction stems -> Limit: composite national indices conceal distribution, gender, disability and ecological dependence.
- **D5 · Underdevelopment can be produced, not merely inherited**. Claim: unequal incorporation into global economic relations generates underdevelopment, rather than it being an earlier stage on one universal path -> Named: dependency approaches -> Use for: critique of modernisation teleology -> Limit: can understate domestic institutional and political factors.

- **D6 · Who authorises the diagnosis?** Claim: post-development critics question the authority by which external experts define whole societies as deficient -> Named: post-development critique -> Use for: paternalism objections -> Limit: romanticising the local can ignore internal hierarchy and genuine demands for health, education and mobility.
- **D7 · Sarvodaya, restraint of wants and trusteeship.** Claim: unlimited wants generate dependence and violence, means shape ends, and self-rule requires economic capacity at the local level -> Named: Gandhi -> Use for: 2020-pattern Gandhian stems -> Limit: ANALYSIS: Ambedkar's objection that the village reproduces caste and patriarchy is compulsory, not optional.
- **D8 · Moral standing is the prior question.** Claim: anthropocentric, biocentric and ecocentric positions differ on what counts morally, not merely on how much nature to protect -> Named: §5A.1 -> Use for: environment-and-development stems -> Limit: ANALYSIS: strong ecocentrism can subordinate individuals to systemic goods; adopt a position and defend it rather than gesturing at harmony.
- **D9 · Depth of questioning, not degree of concern.** Claim: shallow ecology treats symptoms in the interest of affluent human welfare; deep ecology questions the framework that generates them and affirms intrinsic value in non-human life -> Named: Naess (1973) -> Use for: any sustainability stem needing philosophical, not policy, content -> Limit: risks equating subsistence consumption with luxury consumption unless the distinction is drawn.
- **D10 · Permanent aggregate growth is not a coherent universal objective.** Claim: efficiency gains have been offset by expanded output, and beyond a threshold further output adds little to health, longevity or education -> Named: productivism critique and the degrowth argument (§5A.3) -> Use for: limits-of-growth stems -> Limit: FACT: apply asymmetrically - contraction where consumption is far above any defensible threshold, expansion where it is far below. WRONG: Never prescribe degrowth for a society below the deprivation threshold.
- **D11 · Duties run to those not yet born.** Claim: the present generation owes future generations a preserved capacity to meet their own needs, specified as preserving options and avoiding irreversibility -> Named: intergenerational justice; the Brundtland Report, *Our Common Future* (1987), paraphrased -> Use for: sustainability and precaution stems -> Limit: the non-identity problem must be met, and pure time preference defended or rejected explicitly.
- **D12 · Environmentalism of the poor.** Claim: environmental conflict in the global South is typically a struggle over livelihood and access rather than a post-material concern for wilderness -> Named: Guha and Martinez-Alier, *Varieties of Environmentalism* (1997) -> Use for: the single strongest reframing of "development versus environment"; essential on tribal stems -> Limit: it describes the structure of conflict, not the ecological virtue of any community.
- **D13 · Participation is a condition of durable ecological policy, not an obstacle.** Claim: epistemic, compliance, accountability and distributive arguments all tell against insulating ecological decisions from democratic contestation; a just transition conditions restructuring on livelihood guarantees and participation -> Named: §5A.6 -> Use for: the constructive close of any environment stem -> Limit: it does not resolve the timing problem where a threshold is genuinely imminent.
- **D14 · Technology expands power without supplying ends.** Claim: technical capacity alters what can be done but not what ought to be done, so ethical progress does not follow from technological progress -> Named: §3.1 -> Use for: 2019-pattern technology stems -> Limit: technology does reshape the moral problems that arise, so the relation is not simply null - say so.
- **D15 · Indian institutional illustrations, correctly classified.** Claim: PESA (1996) and the Forest Rights Act (2006) are **enacted statutes**; *Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest* (2013) is a **Supreme Court judgment** involving Gram Sabha consideration; Articles 48A and 51A(g) are **non-justiciable** constitutional provisions -> Use for: the Indian paragraph in any 15- or 20-mark answer -> Limit: FACT: enactment, judgment and constitutional commitment are dated legal facts; WRONG: none of them proves reconciliation, implementation or philosophical correctness.

11.5 Graded verdict formulas (adapt; never reproduce mechanically)

- **Modal verdict:** "Economic development is a threshold-level necessary condition and is clearly not a sufficient one: severe material deprivation blocks health, education and voice, while rising output has repeatedly coexisted with intensified unfreedom, humiliation and ecological loss."

- **Conversion verdict:** "Growth becomes progress only through just conversion into capability, dignity and sustainable institutions; the conversion conditions, not the output figure, are where the normative question lies."
- **Agency verdict:** "Development treats persons inadequately when it counts them as beneficiaries but not as agents; participation is both instrumentally useful and constitutive of the end."
- **Reconciliation verdict (tribal stems):** "Development is reconcilable with tribal values only where communities are agents rather than objects - where capabilities destroyed are counted alongside those gained, participation extends to the decision and not only to the compensation, irreversible losses attract a precautionary presumption, and adjustment costs are not shifted onto the least able to bear them."
- **Asymmetric-ecology verdict:** "The ecological limit binds affluent consumption far more tightly than it binds subsistence; a uniform prescription of restraint mistakes an argument about the distribution of ecological burdens for an argument against material improvement as such."
- **Instrument verdict:** "Technology expands the range of what can be done and thereby enlarges the domain of moral choice; it supplies no criterion for choosing, so ethical progress depends on institutions and values rather than on technical capacity."
- **Contested-concept verdict:** "Social progress is normative and multidimensional rather than an automatic law of history; the stem is answerable only after the conception of development it assumes has been made explicit."

11.6 Stem-specific spines

- **For Gandhian development:** *sarvodaya-swarāj*-trusteeship-village -> anti-industrial critique -> Ambedkarite objection on caste and the village -> reconstructed decentralisation under equal rights -> verdict.
- **For skill education:** capability rather than employability -> what skill secures and what it cannot -> obsolescence and work-quality objections -> critical citizenship and dignity of labour -> conditional verdict.
- **For tribal reconciliation:** environmentalism of the poor reframes the question as distributive -> the four tests of §5A.7 -> PESA/FRA/Niyamgiri correctly classified -> verdict on agency.

Link-Outs to Related Topics

- Social and Political Ideals - justice, equality and liberty as criteria of progress.
- Political Ideologies - Marxian, socialist and Gandhian alternatives.
- Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism - universal dignity and cultural plurality.
- Gender Discrimination - empowerment as capability and control over resources.
- Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar - village, caste and social democracy.
- Individual and State - participation, rights and accountability.

Sources

- Local course source, *Socio-Political Philosophy*, sections on development, social progress, human development and Gandhian development.
- O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, chapters on development, social change, environmentalism and Gandhism.
- Amartya Sen, *Development as Freedom* and *Commodities and Capabilities*.
- Martha C. Nussbaum, *Creating Capabilities* and *Women and Human Development*.
- Mahbub ul Haq, *Reflections on Human Development*.
- M. K. Gandhi, *Hind Swaraj* and writings on trusteeship, village *swarāj* and *sarvodaya*.
- B. R. Ambedkar, writings on caste, democracy and the Indian village.
- The Provisions of the Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996 - India Code.
- The Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006 - India Code.
- *Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest* (Supreme Court judgment, 2013), used as a dated judicial illustration of Gram Sabha involvement.
- Arne Naess, the shallow/deep ecology distinction (1973). Cited by position and year only; paraphrased, never quoted.

- World Commission on Environment and Development, *Our Common Future* (the **Brundtland Report, 1987**).
WRONG: Its formulation of sustainable development must be paraphrased, never reproduced verbatim.
- Ramachandra Guha and Joan Martinez-Alier, *Varieties of Environmentalism* (1997) - the environmentalism-of-the-poor thesis. Cited by title and year only.
- The Constitution of India - Legislative Department, Articles 48A and 51A(g), used as dated constitutional illustrations only; both are non-justiciable.

ANALYSIS: Provenance note for \$5A (added in this pass): the ecological political-philosophy module is a named-scholar reconstruction adapted into this Philosophy owner. No page, chapter, edition or verbatim wording is asserted for Naess, Guha, Martinez-Alier or the Brundtland Report, and **no** environmental datum, target, figure, project, company, movement or region is named. Environmental facts, policy and data belong to the Environment -and- Ecology and Governance areas of this repository, not here; this section supplies philosophy only.

ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 48 QUESTIONS

Questions 1-40 are core coverage - four per subtopic across the ten subtopics; Questions 41-48 are remedial items targeting the most common misreadings. Correct answers rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D 12 times.

MCQ 1

Which statement best captures the canonical distinction between economic growth and social progress?

A. Growth is a quantitative rise in output that is at most a possible means, whereas social progress is an evaluative judgement that a change is good and fairly shared. B. Growth and social progress are synonyms, both measured by per-capita income. C. Social progress is descriptive while growth is normative. D. Growth necessarily guarantees social progress once average income rises.

Answer: A. Growth is a quantitative rise in output that is at most a possible means, whereas social progress is an evaluative judgement that a change is good and fairly shared.

Explanation: Growth is a quantitative, means-level fact; social progress is a normative, value-level judgement. They are not synonyms, the descriptive/normative labels are reversed in (C), and averages hide distribution so (D) fails.

MCQ 2

The 'economistic model' of development commits which characteristic error?

A. It denies that income has any instrumental value at all. B. A category slide - treating a means (income) and an average (per-head output) as if they were the end (a good life) and its fair distribution. C. It over-emphasises capabilities at the expense of growth. D. It reduces development entirely to ecological limits.

Answer: B. A category slide - treating a means (income) and an average (per-head output) as if they were the end (a good life) and its fair distribution.

Explanation: The economistic model slides from means to end and from average to distribution; it does not deny income's instrumental value, nor over-weight capabilities or ecology.

MCQ 3

'Growth can finance development, but only capabilities, justice, participation and ecological limits convert material change into social progress.' In the canonical file this master thesis is:

A. A verbatim quotation from Amartya Sen. B. A binding constitutional provision. C. The file's own analytical synthesis (flagged as analysis), to be argued rather than cited as a quotation. D. A Supreme Court holding.

Answer: C. The file's own analytical synthesis (flagged as analysis), to be argued rather than cited as a quotation.

Explanation: The master thesis is marked analytical synthesis; it must be argued as a reasoned position, not attributed as a quotation, provision or judgment.

MCQ 4

Which sequence correctly orders the three rungs from means to justified end?

A. Progress -> development -> growth. B. Development -> growth -> progress. C. Growth -> progress -> development. D. Growth -> development -> social progress.

Answer: D. Growth -> development -> social progress.

Explanation: The ladder runs growth (means) -> development (structural + human change) -> social progress (justified value); only (D) preserves that order.

MCQ 5

In Sen's capability approach, a 'capability' is best defined as:

A. The real freedom - the set of genuine opportunities - a person has to achieve valuable functionings. B. The bundle of commodities a person owns. C. A subjective feeling of satisfaction. D. An achieved doing or being, such as being nourished.

Answer: A. The real freedom - the set of genuine opportunities - a person has to achieve valuable functionings.

Explanation: Capability is real freedom/opportunity; commodities are resources (B), satisfaction is utility (C), and an achieved doing/being is a functioning (D).

MCQ 6

'Conversion factors' in the capability approach explain why:

A. Utility is the correct metric of well-being. B. People with the same resources can have very different real freedoms, because personal, social and environmental factors differ. C. Income always translates one-to-one into functionings. D. Adaptive preferences are irrelevant to well-being.

Answer: B. People with the same resources can have very different real freedoms, because personal, social and environmental factors differ.

Explanation: Conversion factors mean equal resources yield unequal real freedom; they refute the utility metric (A), the one-to-one claim (C) and the dismissal of adaptive preferences (D).

MCQ 7

The phenomenon of 'adaptive preferences' warns that:

A. Capabilities can be read directly off national income. B. Functionings and capabilities are identical. C. The deprived may report contentment because they have adjusted their wants downward, so satisfaction is an unreliable measure of well-being. D. Agency is unimportant in development.

Answer: C. The deprived may report contentment because they have adjusted their wants downward, so satisfaction is an unreliable measure of well-being.

Explanation: Adaptive preferences make expressed satisfaction unreliable; they do not license reading capability off income (A), equate functioning and capability (B), or downgrade agency (D).

MCQ 8

The Sen-Nussbaum difference is best stated as:

A. Sen rejects capabilities while Nussbaum accepts them. B. Both reduce well-being to utility. C. Nussbaum leaves capabilities entirely to the market. D. Both centre capability, but Sen leaves the list open to public reasoning while Nussbaum defends a threshold list of central capabilities.

Answer: D. Both centre capability, but Sen leaves the list open to public reasoning while Nussbaum defends a threshold list of central capabilities.

Explanation: Both share the capability core; the split is over specification - Sen's open list via public reasoning versus Nussbaum's threshold list. (A), (B) and (C) misstate both positions.

MCQ 9

The dependency critique primarily argues that:

A. Underdevelopment can be actively produced by unequal relations between centre and periphery, so progress concerns power and terms of trade, not merely internal effort. B. Poor regions are simply 'behind' and must copy rich ones exactly. C. Development is purely a discourse with no material dimension. D. Ecological limits are the only constraint on development.

Answer: A. Underdevelopment can be actively produced by unequal relations between centre and periphery, so progress concerns power and terms of trade, not merely internal effort.

Explanation: Dependency stresses centre-periphery power and terms of trade; (B) is the stage-theory it rejects, (C) is post-development over-stated, and (D) is the ecological frame, not dependency.

MCQ 10

A disciplined use of the post-development critique avoids which over-reach?

A. Questioning the neutrality of the vocabulary of 'development'. B. Romanticising poverty and denying that the poor themselves demand health, schooling and capabilities. C. Recognising plural conceptions of a good life. D. Criticising one-size-fits-all development models.

Answer: B. Romanticising poverty and denying that the poor themselves demand health, schooling and capabilities.

Explanation: The over-reach to avoid is romanticising deprivation; (A), (C) and (D) are legitimate uses of the critique.

MCQ 11

The distinction between 'weak' and 'strong' sustainability turns on:

A. Whether growth is measured in rupees or in dollars. B. Whether development is urban or rural. C. Whether natural capital is broadly substitutable by man-made capital (weak) or some natural functions are non-substitutable and set hard limits (strong). D. Whether HDI is higher than GDP.

Answer: C. Whether natural capital is broadly substitutable by man-made capital (weak) or some natural functions are non-substitutable and set hard limits (strong).

Explanation: Weak vs strong sustainability is exactly the substitutability of natural capital; the other options are irrelevant contrasts.

MCQ 12

To say that 'development versus environment' is a false dichotomy means:

A. The environment should always be sacrificed for development. B. Development should always be halted to protect the environment. C. Environment and development are wholly unrelated. D. The real question is which development, distributed how, and within which limits - not development or environment as an either/or.

Answer: D. The real question is which development, distributed how, and within which limits - not development or environment as an either/or.

Explanation: The false-dichotomy point reframes the question as which/how/within-what-limits; (A), (B) and (C) each keep or misread the either/or.

MCQ 13

To call a change 'social progress' rather than mere 'change' is to:

A. Add a value judgement that the change is good on some stated, defended criterion. B. Simply record that the change occurred. C. Measure only the rise in output. D. Assert that the change was historically inevitable.

Answer: A. Add a value judgement that the change is good on some stated, defended criterion.

Explanation: Progress is a criterion-relative value claim that must be defended; it is not a bare record (B), an output measure (C) or a claim of inevitability (D).

MCQ 14

The canonical position on whether social progress is inevitable is that:

A. Progress is a guaranteed linear law of history. B. Progress is real but contingent, plural and reversible - not an automatic law of history. C. Progress never occurs. D. Progress is identical to economic growth.

Answer: B. Progress is real but contingent, plural and reversible - not an automatic law of history.

Explanation: The file affirms progress as genuine yet contingent and reversible, rejecting both the linear-law view (A) and the denial of progress (C), and the growth-equation (D).

MCQ 15

Which trio names the sceptical replies to the idea of inevitable, linear progress?

A. Utilitarian, liberal, socialist. B. Weak, strong, neutral. C. Cyclical/tragic, pluralist, and postcolonial critiques. D. Anthropocentric, biocentric, ecocentric.

Answer: C. Cyclical/tragic, pluralist, and postcolonial critiques.

Explanation: The replies to inevitability are cyclical/tragic, pluralist and postcolonial; the other trios belong to different debates (ideologies, sustainability, moral standing).

MCQ 16

The postcolonial objection to 'universal progress' warns that:

A. Progress can never be multidimensional. B. Values never conflict. C. Technology always improves ethics. D. A single 'universal' path has often encoded one culture's trajectory as the yardstick, delegitimising others.

Answer: D. A single 'universal' path has often encoded one culture's trajectory as the yardstick, delegitimising others.

Explanation: The postcolonial point is that a supposedly universal path universalises one culture's trajectory; (A), (B) and (C) are unrelated or false.

MCQ 17

That the criteria of social progress are 'plural and sometimes conflicting' implies:

A. Gains on one value (e.g., liberty) can coincide with losses on another (e.g., equality), so progress is rarely one-dimensional and must be argued across axes. B. Only one criterion - income - ultimately matters. C. The criteria never conflict with one another. D. Progress is a single guaranteed ranking for every society.

Answer: A. Gains on one value (e.g., liberty) can coincide with losses on another (e.g., equality), so progress is rarely one-dimensional and must be argued across axes.

Explanation: Plural, conflicting criteria make progress multidimensional and argued; (B), (C) and (D) each deny the plurality or the conflict.

MCQ 18

The distinction between redistribution and recognition holds that:

A. Recognition alone, without resources, always suffices for justice. B. Injustice concerns both the distribution of goods and status/identity, so pure redistribution can leave status hierarchies (caste, gender, disability) intact. C. Redistribution and recognition are identical. D. Only redistribution matters for social progress.

Answer: B. Injustice concerns both the distribution of goods and status/identity, so pure redistribution can leave status hierarchies (caste, gender, disability) intact.

Explanation: Justice needs both goods (redistribution) and status (recognition); (A) over-weights recognition, (C) conflates them, and (D) drops recognition.

MCQ 19

Describing democratic participation as 'constitutive' of development means:

A. It is merely a useful instrument for reaching better decisions. B. It is irrelevant to development. C. Being able to take part is itself part of a developed life (agency), not only a means to other goods. D. It guarantees economic growth.

Answer: C. Being able to take part is itself part of a developed life (agency), not only a means to other goods.

Explanation: Constitutive means participation is itself part of development (agency); (A) captures only its instrumental role, and (B) and (D) are false.

MCQ 20

On the 2024 necessary/sufficient question, the examiner-grade verdict is that economic development is:

A. Both necessary and sufficient for social progress. B. Sufficient but not necessary. C. Strictly necessary in every case. D. At most a necessary enabler and never sufficient - strictly neither necessary in every case nor ever sufficient.

Answer: D. At most a necessary enabler and never sufficient - strictly neither necessary in every case nor ever sufficient.

Explanation: The material-threshold nuance yields 'necessary-enabler at most, never sufficient', which is neither strictly necessary in every case nor ever sufficient; (A), (B) and (C) misstate the modal analysis.

MCQ 21

The disciplined answer to 'does technological development raise the ethical standards of society?' is:

A. Not on its own - technology expands power and reshapes the ethical terrain, but ethical progress is a value-level achievement secured by ends and institutions. B. Yes automatically, because capacity and morality are the same thing. C. No, because technology has no ethical relevance whatsoever. D. Yes, because greater output is the same as greater goodness.

Answer: A. Not on its own - technology expands power and reshapes the ethical terrain, but ethical progress is a value-level achievement secured by ends and institutions.

Explanation: Technology changes the ethical terrain without raising standards on its own; (B) conflates capacity with morality, (C) denies all relevance, and (D) equates output with goodness.

MCQ 22

Calling technology 'not self-justifying' means:

A. Technology should never be used at all. B. Whether new power counts as progress depends on the ends it serves and the institutions that govern it, not on the technology itself. C. Technology automatically justifies any outcome it produces. D. Technology is identical to ethical progress.

Answer: B. Whether new power counts as progress depends on the ends it serves and the institutions that govern it, not on the technology itself.

Explanation: Not self-justifying means ends and institutions decide whether power becomes progress; (A) is Luddism, and (C) and (D) are exactly the errors the phrase denies.

MCQ 23

The strongest evaluative limit on the claim 'skill education enhances development' is that:

A. Skills never raise employability. B. Skills are identical to capabilities. C. Employability is not the same as capability - market-directed skilling can produce capable workers who remain unfree (precarious, voiceless, unrecognised). D. Development requires no material base whatsoever.

Answer: C. Employability is not the same as capability - market-directed skilling can produce capable workers who remain unfree (precarious, voiceless, unrecognised).

Explanation: The limit is that employability is not capability; (A) and (B) are false, and (D) contradicts the material-threshold point.

MCQ 24

An 'Evaluate' verdict on skill education (2023) should conclude that it:

A. Never enhances development under any conditions. B. Always and unconditionally enhances development. C. Is wholly irrelevant to development. D. Enhances development conditionally - when it expands genuine capabilities and agency, not mere labour-market throughput.

Answer: D. Enhances development conditionally - when it expands genuine capabilities and agency, not mere labour-market throughput.

Explanation: The graded verdict is conditional enhancement; (A), (B) and (C) are the one-sided answers 'Evaluate' is designed to exclude.

MCQ 25

In Gandhian thought, 'trusteeship' means that:

A. The wealthy hold their surplus in trust for society rather than as an absolute private right. B. The state nationalises all private property by force. C. Wealth should be accumulated without any limit. D. Manual labour is degrading and should be avoided.

Answer: A. The wealthy hold their surplus in trust for society rather than as an absolute private right.

Explanation: Trusteeship treats surplus wealth as held in trust for society; (B) is state seizure, (C) is unlimited accumulation, and (D) contradicts dignity of labour.

MCQ 26

'Sarvodaya' is best rendered as:

- A. Rule by a technical elite. B. The welfare and uplift of all, tested by the condition of the last and weakest person. C. The maximisation of aggregate national output. D. The pursuit of unlimited wants.

Answer: B. The welfare and uplift of all, tested by the condition of the last and weakest person.

Explanation: Sarvodaya is the uplift of all, measured by the last person's condition; the other options describe technocracy, output-maximisation and consumerism, all of which Gandhi rejects.

MCQ 27

The decisive internal-Indian objection to the Gandhian village model is that:

- A. It over-industrialises society. B. It ignores ecological limits. C. Idealising the village can reproduce caste hierarchy and gendered labour (the Ambedkar objection). D. It abandons the idea of the dignity of labour.

Answer: C. Idealising the village can reproduce caste hierarchy and gendered labour (the Ambedkar objection).

Explanation: Ambedkar's objection is that the idealised village reproduces caste and gender hierarchy; (A) and (B) misdescribe the model, and (D) contradicts a core Gandhian commitment.

MCQ 28

Gandhian 'means-ends unity' asserts that:

- A. Any means is acceptable provided the end is good. B. Ends and means are wholly unrelated. C. Only the ends matter in politics and economics. D. A good end cannot be achieved through exploitative or violent means; the means shape the end.

Answer: D. A good end cannot be achieved through exploitative or violent means; the means shape the end.

Explanation: Means-ends unity holds that means shape ends, so good ends need good means; (A), (B) and (C) each sever that link.

MCQ 29

In the reconciliation model, the 'participation test' requires that tribal communities:

- A. Share in the decision itself, not merely receive compensation after it is taken. B. Are compensated generously in cash after displacement. C. Are excluded from planning in the name of efficiency. D. Abandon their distinct conception of a good life.

Answer: A. Share in the decision itself, not merely receive compensation after it is taken.

Explanation: Participation means a share in the decision, not post-hoc compensation (B); (C) and (D) are exactly what the model rules out.

MCQ 30

PESA 1996 and the Forest Rights Act 2006 should be used in a philosophy answer as:

A. Proof that the philosophical thesis about tribal values is true. B. Dated legal facts of institutional recognition (Gram Sabha powers; forest rights) that illustrate, but do not by themselves prove, the argument. C. Non-binding moral opinions with no legal status. D. Supreme Court judgments.

Answer: B. Dated legal facts of institutional recognition (Gram Sabha powers; forest rights) that illustrate, but do not by themselves prove, the argument.

Explanation: They are enacted statutes used as legal facts of recognition, not as philosophical proof (A), not opinions without status (C), and not judgments (D).

MCQ 31

The 'irreversibility test' in the reconciliation model implies that:

A. All development should proceed regardless of permanent loss. B. Compensation can always offset any loss whatsoever. C. Where loss is permanent (a sacred landscape, an ecosystem, a language), a precautionary presumption operates against the project. D. Reversible and irreversible losses are to be treated identically.

Answer: C. Where loss is permanent (a sacred landscape, an ecosystem, a language), a precautionary presumption operates against the project.

Explanation: Irreversibility triggers a precautionary presumption against the project; (A), (B) and (D) all ignore the special weight of permanent loss.

MCQ 32

Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest (2013) is correctly described as:

A. A statute enacted by Parliament. B. A non-justiciable Directive Principle of State Policy. C. A fabricated illustration with no legal status. D. A Supreme Court judgment in which Gram Sabha consideration featured in the Niyamgiri context.

Answer: D. A Supreme Court judgment in which Gram Sabha consideration featured in the Niyamgiri context.

Explanation: It is a Supreme Court judgment; it is not a statute (A), not a Directive Principle (B), and it is a real, correctly classified legal fact (not C).

MCQ 33

Arne Naess's (1973) distinction between 'shallow' and 'deep' ecology contrasts:

A. Reforming pollution to protect human interests (shallow) with rethinking the human-nature relationship itself (deep). B. Weak versus strong sustainability. C. Redistribution versus recognition. D. Necessary versus sufficient conditions.

Answer: A. Reforming pollution to protect human interests (shallow) with rethinking the human-nature relationship itself (deep).

Explanation: Shallow ecology reforms for human interests; deep ecology rethinks the relationship. The other pairs belong to different debates.

MCQ 34

The 'non-identity problem' in intergenerational justice observes that:

- A. Future generations have no moral status at all. B. Because present choices determine which future people exist, it is puzzling to say we 'harm' specific future individuals - which motivates impersonal duties and precaution instead. C. We can never affect the future in any way. D. Natural capital is always fully substitutable.

Answer: B. Because present choices determine which future people exist, it is puzzling to say we 'harm' specific future individuals - which motivates impersonal duties and precaution instead.

Explanation: The non-identity problem shifts the ground from person-affecting harm to impersonal duties and precaution; (A), (C) and (D) misstate the problem and its context.

MCQ 35

Why is a blanket 'degrowth' prescription treated as asymmetric for a country like India?

- A. Because degrowth has no ecological rationale. B. Because productivism is always the correct policy. C. Because a country with large unmet basic needs requires capability expansion at the base, so the disciplined position couples sufficiency at the top with base-level capability under ecological limits. D. Because ecological limits do not apply to India.

Answer: C. Because a country with large unmet basic needs requires capability expansion at the base, so the disciplined position couples sufficiency at the top with base-level capability under ecological limits.

Explanation: The asymmetry is that base-level capability expansion is still needed, so sufficiency-at-top is coupled with capability-at-base; (A), (B) and (D) are all false.

MCQ 36

The 'environmentalism of the poor' (Guha and Martinez-Alier, 1997) foregrounds:

- A. The claim that only the wealthy genuinely care about nature. B. That ecological concern is purely aesthetic. C. That environmental protection always conflicts with justice. D. Distributive ecological conflict - who bears the environmental costs of development now - linking ecology to justice for the poor.

Answer: D. Distributive ecological conflict - who bears the environmental costs of development now - linking ecology to justice for the poor.

Explanation: It centres distributive ecological conflict and the poor who bear present costs; (A), (B) and (C) invert or trivialise the idea.

MCQ 37

The 'growth model vs Sen' debate is best summarised as a dispute over:

A. The metric of development - income/output versus capability/real freedom - with Sen winning on what development is for and growth retained as an enabler. B. Whether ecology matters to development. C. Whether the village reproduces caste. D. Whether technology is self-justifying.

Answer: A. The metric of development - income/output versus capability/real freedom - with Sen winning on what development is for and growth retained as an enabler.

Explanation: Growth-vs-Sen is a metric war (income vs capability); the other options name different debates in the clause.

MCQ 38

In the model matrix, the 'key danger' of the human-development / capability model is:

A. The category slide of treating income as the end. B. Index-worship and the difficulty of measuring capabilities. C. Eco-authoritarianism. D. Reproducing caste hierarchy.

Answer: B. Index-worship and the difficulty of measuring capabilities.

Explanation: The capability model's characteristic danger is index-worship/measurement difficulty; the category slide is the economic model's danger (A), eco-authoritarianism the ecological model's (C), and caste-reproduction the Gandhian village critique (D).

MCQ 39

Which of the following is a canonical 'common trap' the clause warns against?

A. Carefully distinguishing growth, development and progress. B. Naming the value criterion in a progress claim. C. Citing statutes such as PESA or the Forest Rights Act as if they were philosophical proof of a thesis. D. Applying the four tribal-reconciliation tests.

Answer: C. Citing statutes such as PESA or the Forest Rights Act as if they were philosophical proof of a thesis.

Explanation: Treating statutes as philosophical proof is a listed trap; (A), (B) and (D) are exactly the good practices the clause recommends.

MCQ 40

The recommended 'final answer spine' for any development stem runs:

A. Thesis -> conclusion, skipping objections entirely. B. Verdict first, followed by unrelated facts. C. A chronological list of dates with no argument. D. Directive -> thesis -> ladder/capability -> model contrast -> limit + justice -> objection/reply -> graded verdict.

Answer: D. Directive -> thesis -> ladder/capability -> model contrast -> limit + justice -> objection/reply -> graded verdict.

Explanation: The universal spine is the full directive-to-verdict architecture in (D); (A), (B) and (C) omit the reasoning that earns marks.

Remedial MCQ 41

A candidate writes: 'GDP rose, therefore society progressed.' The core error is:

A. Conflating growth (a quantitative means) with social progress (a defended value claim), ignoring distribution, agency and ecological cost. B. Correctly identifying the necessary and sufficient conditions of progress. C. Over-applying the capability approach. D. Romanticising the village economy.

Answer: A. Conflating growth (a quantitative means) with social progress (a defended value claim), ignoring distribution, agency and ecological cost.

Explanation: The error is the growth-equals-progress slide, which ignores distribution, agency and ecological cost; the other options misdescribe the mistake.

Remedial MCQ 42

A candidate defines Sen's 'capability' as 'income plus welfare schemes.' The correction is:

A. Capability is simply the same as utility. B. Capability is the real freedom to achieve valuable functionings; income and schemes are resources whose value depends on conversion into that freedom. C. Capability is a bundle of commodities. D. Capability is an achieved functioning such as being nourished.

Answer: B. Capability is the real freedom to achieve valuable functionings; income and schemes are resources whose value depends on conversion into that freedom.

Explanation: Capability is real freedom, not resources (income/schemes/commodities) and not utility (A) or an achieved functioning (D).

Remedial MCQ 43

A candidate treats HDI as a complete measure of social progress. The correction is:

A. HDI already captures every dimension of progress. B. HDI is a fabricated index with no basis. C. HDI is a useful but partial proxy - indicators embody values and aggregate averages hide distribution, so measurement is not the same as progress. D. HDI measures only ecological limits.

Answer: C. HDI is a useful but partial proxy - indicators embody values and aggregate averages hide distribution, so measurement is not the same as progress.

Explanation: HDI is a partial proxy: averages hide distribution and measurement is not progress; (A) over-claims, (B) is false, and (D) misdescribes it.

Remedial MCQ 44

A candidate answers the 2019 stem with 'technology automatically raises ethical standards.' The correction is:

A. Technology has no relation to ethics at all. B. Capacity and morality are simply identical. C. Ethical standards necessarily fall whenever technology advances. D. Technology expands power and reshapes the ethical terrain, but ethical progress is a separate value-level achievement secured by ends and institutions.

Answer: D. Technology expands power and reshapes the ethical terrain, but ethical progress is a separate value-level achievement secured by ends and institutions.

Explanation: Technology changes the terrain without raising standards on its own; (A), (B) and (C) are each one-sided errors the disciplined answer avoids.

Remedial MCQ 45

A candidate praises Gandhi's model of development without mentioning its decisive Indian objection. The missing point is:

A. The Ambedkar objection - idealising the village can reproduce caste hierarchy and gendered labour. B. That Gandhi ignored ecological limits. C. That Gandhi sought to maximise aggregate output. D. That trusteeship means state seizure of property.

Answer: A. The Ambedkar objection - idealising the village can reproduce caste hierarchy and gendered labour.

Explanation: The decisive missing objection is Ambedkar's caste-and-gender critique of the idealised village; (B), (C) and (D) misdescribe Gandhi's position.

Remedial MCQ 46

A candidate answers the 2024 stem with a flat 'necessary but not sufficient' and stops. The refinement that earns the 5-mark judgement split is:

A. That economic development is in fact sufficient after all. B. The material-threshold / both-neither nuance: a necessary enabler for broad progress, yet not strictly necessary in every case (limited gains via redistribution and recognition) and never sufficient. C. That economic development is wholly irrelevant to progress. D. That 'necessary' and 'sufficient' mean the same thing.

Answer: B. The material-threshold / both-neither nuance: a necessary enabler for broad progress, yet not strictly necessary in every case (limited gains via redistribution and recognition) and never sufficient.

Explanation: The 5-mark refinement is the both-neither nuance beyond the flat formula; (A), (C) and (D) are analytic errors.

Remedial MCQ 47

A candidate concludes that reconciling development with tribal values is impossible because all development is imposition. The correction is:

A. Tribal communities never demand capabilities such as health or schooling. B. Compensation alone fully reconciles development with tribal values. C. This romanticises deprivation and denies tribal agency; reconciliation is possible when development shifts to shared decision-power and passes the capability, participation, irreversibility and burden tests. D. Statutes such as PESA prove that reconciliation is automatic.

Answer: C. This romanticises deprivation and denies tribal agency; reconciliation is possible when development shifts to shared decision-power and passes the capability, participation, irreversibility and burden tests.

Explanation: The correction rejects both romanticising and steamrolling and specifies the four tests plus shared decision-power; (A), (B) and (D) are each mistaken.

Remedial MCQ 48

A candidate cites Articles 48A and 51A(g) as enforceable guarantees that prove an environmental duty. The correction is:

A. They are Supreme Court judgments. B. They are enacted statutes like PESA and the Forest Rights Act. C. They are fabricated provisions with no textual basis. D. They are non-justiciable constitutional provisions - a Directive Principle and a Fundamental Duty - which are dated legal facts, not enforceable guarantees or philosophical proof.

Answer: D. They are non-justiciable constitutional provisions - a Directive Principle and a Fundamental Duty - which are dated legal facts, not enforceable guarantees or philosophical proof.

Explanation: Articles 48A and 51A(g) are non-justiciable provisions used as dated facts, not enforceable guarantees or proof; they are not judgments (A), statutes (B) or fabricated (C).

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

EXAM APPLICATION 1 - Growth, Development and Progress - the Core Distinction

Which PYQs this subtopic controls

- **2022 Q3(a), 20** - "economic development does not on its own lead to human development and social progress" is *exactly* this ladder: economic development (rung 1-2 in economic form) does not guarantee human development (rung 2) or social progress (rung 3).
- **2024 Q3(c), 10+5=15** - the necessary/sufficient question is the ladder in modal form: is the lower rung a *necessary* input, a *sufficient* one, both, or neither? (Answered fully in Subtopic 5.)

Directive-sensitive architecture (20-mark "Do you agree...")

THESIS	: agree with a qualification - economic development is a means, not a guarantee, of human development and social progress.
LADDER	: define growth / development / progress; show two gaps (distribution gap; conversion gap).
EVIDENCE	: one named unit from the bank (D-series) or the capability map.
OBJECTION	: "but no country progressed without growth" -> reply: necessary enabling condition, not sufficient cause.
VERDICT	: graded - economic development is enabling but must be converted, under justice and ecological limits, into capabilities.

EXAM APPLICATION 2 - Human Development and the Capability Approach - Sen, Nussbaum, Haq

Which PYQs this subtopic controls

- **2022 Q3(a), 20** - "human development and social progress" is *this* vocabulary; the capability map is the engine that shows why economic development alone does not deliver it.
- Feeds every stem that turns on **agency, distribution or well-being** rather than output.

Directive-sensitive architecture (define -> deploy)

DEFINE : functioning / capability / agency in one clean line each.
MAP : resource -> conversion -> functioning -> capability -> agency.
CONTRAST : Sen (open list, public reasoning) vs Nussbaum (threshold list).
DEPLOY : adaptive preferences => satisfaction is not proof of well-being.
GUARD : HDI is a proxy; capabilities exceed what any index captures.

EXAM APPLICATION 3 - Dependency, Post-Development and Sustainable Development

Which PYQs this subtopic controls (as support, not owner)

- No *owned* PYQ is a pure dependency/post-development stem - so these are **supporting frames**, deployed inside capability, tribal and ecological answers, never padded in as a separate essay.
- Where a stem invites a **critique of imposed models** (e.g., tribal values, 2025), dependency/post-development supply the "on whose terms?" move; sustainability supplies the "within what limits?" move.

Directive-sensitive architecture (deploy-as-lens)

TRIGGER : stem attacks "one model for all" or "development that displaces".
LENS 1 : dependency -> question the terms and who benefits.
LENS 2 : post-dev -> question the vocabulary, keep the poor's real demands.
LENS 3 : sustainable -> bound the answer by ecological limits + future people.
GUARD : do not romanticise poverty; retain capabilities and agency.

EXAM APPLICATION 4 - Social Progress - Is It Inevitable?

Which PYQs this subtopic controls

- Supplies the **normativity + anti-inevitability** spine that strengthens **2022 Q3(a)** (why economic development does not *automatically* yield social progress) and **2024 Q3(c)** (necessary/sufficient - the modal form of "not inevitable").
- Any "will X lead to progress?" stem (e.g., technology 2019, skill 2023) needs this move: progress is a *defended value claim*, so "leads to" must be argued, never assumed.

Directive-sensitive architecture ("Is progress inevitable?" / "does X lead to progress?")

FRAME : distinguish change (fact) from progress (value).
CRITERION: name the value you are judging by (freedom / justice / capability).
DENY : reject inevitability - cyclical, pluralist, postcolonial replies.
TEST : does X meet the criterion AND avoid sacrificing another core value?
VERDICT : graded - "progressive on axis A, at cost on axis B; net-defended if..."

EXAM APPLICATION 5 - Criteria, Necessary/Sufficient, Recognition and Democracy

Which PYQs this subtopic controls

- **2024 Q3(c), 10+5=15 (OWNED)** - the necessary/sufficient grid *is* the answer skeleton; the 10+5 split rewards (10) the clean modal analysis and (5) the reasoned verdict with the material-threshold nuance.
- **2022 Q3(a), 20 (OWNED)** - "does not on its own lead to..." is the **not-sufficient** claim; deploy the dashboard + redistribution/recognition + democracy to show the gaps.

Directive-sensitive architecture ("necessary / sufficient / both / neither")

DEFINE : necessary condition vs sufficient condition (one line each).
 NEC? : material threshold => plausibly a necessary ENABLER (qualify).
 SUFF? : counter-cases (inequality, exclusion, ecology, lost agency) => NO.
 NUANCE : neither strictly necessary in every case nor ever sufficient.
 VERDICT : "necessary-enabling at most, converted by justice + agency + limits."

EXAM APPLICATION 6 - Technology, Ethics and Skill Education

Which PYQs this subtopic controls

- **2019 Q2(c), 15 (OWNED)** - "does technological development lead to progress in the ethical standards of the society?" -> the technology risk map + fact/value gap; answer "not automatically", argue both sides, give a graded verdict.
- **2023 Q2(c), 15 (OWNED)** - "will the emphasis on skill education enhance development?" -> skills as *conditional enabler*; distinguish employability from capability/agency; "Evaluate" demands a two-sided, graded reply.

Directive-sensitive architecture ("Explain" 2019 / "Evaluate" 2023)

2019 "Explain": claim -> distinguish capacity vs morality -> new ethical harms
 -> ends + institutions decide -> verdict "changes terrain, not standards on its own."
 2023 "Evaluate": gains of skilling -> limits (voice, precarity, distribution)
 -> capability test -> verdict "enhances development IF it expands capabilities and agency, not mere employability."

EXAM APPLICATION 7 - Gandhian Social Development

Which PYQs this subtopic controls

- **2020 Q2(a), 20 (OWNED)** - "State and examine the Gandhian concept of social development." "State" = expound the wheel faithfully; "examine" = weigh it with the objection/reply set (scale, productivity, caste/gender) and a graded verdict.

Directive-sensitive architecture ("State and examine", 20)

STATE : sarvodaya (hub) + swaraj + trusteeship + restraint + dignity of labour
 + decentralisation/appropriate tech; means-ends unity.
 EXAMINE : strengths (ecological restraint, dignity, anti-exploitation)
 vs objections (scale, productivity, caste/gender - Ambedkar).
 BALANCE : concede the caste/gender critique honestly; retain the ecological + sufficiency insight.
 VERDICT : "a powerful critique of consumerist, centralised development and a partial positive model, corrected by Ambedkar on caste."

EXAM APPLICATION 8 - Development and Tribal Values - the Reconciliation Model

Which PYQs this subtopic controls

- **2025 Q3(c), 15 (OWNED)** - "Is it possible to reconcile development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress? Discuss." -> the four-test model *is* the answer; conclude "yes, conditionally", specifying the conditions.

Directive-sensitive architecture ("Is it possible... Discuss", 15)

FRAME : development-as-extraction vs development-as-capability-expansion.
 MODEL : run the four tests (capability, participation, irreversibility, burden).
 LAW : PESA 1996 / FRA 2006 / Orissa Mining 2013 / Arts 48A, 51A(g) as
 FACTS of legal recognition - not as philosophical proof.
 GUARD : do not romanticise (deny tribal demand for capabilities) OR steamroll
 (deny agency); reconciliation = shared decision-power.
 VERDICT : "reconciliation is possible IF the four tests are met and consent is
 real; otherwise it is displacement mislabelled as development."

EXAM APPLICATION 9 - Ecological Political Philosophy and the Limits of Development

Which PYQs this subtopic controls (as the binding frame)

- No *owned* PYQ is a pure ecology stem, but §5A **bounds every development answer**: the "within what limits?" move in 2022/2024, the irreversibility test in 2025, and the ecological-cost harm in the 2019 technology answer.
- Deploy it as the **limit-and-justice frame**, never as a bolt-on essay.

Directive-sensitive architecture (deploy-the-triangle)

STANDING : place the stem on anthropo/bio/ecocentric + shallow/deep (Naess 1973).
LIMIT : invoke finite throughput; weak vs strong sustainability.
JUSTICE : two axes - future generations (non-identity) + poor now (Guha 1997).
INDIA : couple sufficiency-at-top with capability-expansion-at-base (avoid blanket degrowth); pair limits with a JUST TRANSITION (not eco-authoritarian).
GUARD : cite 48A/51A(g) as non-justiciable; no datum, target or region.

EXAM APPLICATION 10 - Inter-School Debates, Criticisms and Common Traps

Which PYQs this subtopic controls

- This is the **synthesis toolkit** for *all six owned* PYQs: the model matrix supplies contrasts, the spine supplies structure, and the traps supply the "what not to write" discipline.
- For any high-mark stem, one debate + the spine + a graded verdict is the reliable skeleton.

Directive-sensitive architecture (the universal spine)

DIRECTIVE : decode the verb (Explain / Examine / Evaluate / Discuss / Do you agree).
THESIS : one defended sentence answering the exact demand.
BODY : ladder or capability map -> one model contrast -> limit + justice frame.
TENSION : one objection + reply + residual (never a straw man).
VERDICT : graded, qualified, India-aware - not a slogan.
DISCIPLINE: no fabricated quote/date/statistic; statutes as facts, not proof.

Workbook Source Audit

- Exact PYQ wording, year and marks: local Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II bank, 2018-2025.
- Exactly 6 owner questions (2018:0, 2019:1, 2020:1, 2021:0, 2022:1, 2023:1, 2024:1, 2025:1).
- Ownership discipline: caste-and-village stems (Caste Discrimination), gender-as-capability stems (Gender Discrimination), abstract justice/equality/liberty framing (Social and Political Ideals), ideology-label stems (Political Ideologies), universal-dignity and plurality stems (Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism) and environmental policy/data (Environment and Governance areas) are kept separate and not double-owned here.
- Model solutions authored at examiner grade: thesis -> doctrine in canonical terms -> named evidence unit (D1-D15) or Indian legal example -> objection/reply/residual -> graded verdict, each closing with a "Why this earns marks" note.
- MCQs: 40 core plus 8 remedial, exactly 48, strict A-B-C-D rotation 12 times.
- Original Mains: one solved 10-marker, one solved 15-marker and one solved 20-marker.
- Provenance discipline observed throughout: Sen, Nussbaum, Mahbub ul Haq/UNDP, Gandhi, Ambedkar, Naess (1973), the Brundtland Report (1987, paraphrased) and Guha and Martinez-Alier (1997) by position and standard title only; the PESA Act 1996 and the Forest Rights Act 2006 as enacted statutes, Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest (2013) as a Supreme Court judgment, and Articles 48A and 51A(g) as non-justiciable constitutional provisions - dated facts, not philosophical proof; no environmental datum, target, project or region named.
- No current-affairs anchor is used (no verified 2026 development forced); relevance is static and syllabus-driven.
- Final consolidated register notes are intentionally excluded from this workbook.

Practice Design

The workbook sequence is the 6 exact verified PYQs -> 40 core MCQs -> 8 remedial MCQs -> original 10/15/20-mark Mains practice. There are no register notes and no canonical apparatus block in this workbook.

DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> DOCTRINE -> NAMED EVIDENCE (D1-D15) / EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION / REPLY /
RESIDUAL -> VERDICT

SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 6 VERIFIED OWNER QUESTIONS

Exact wording, year and marks are parsed from the local Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II bank for 2018-2025. This clause owns exactly 6 primary parts (2018:0, 2019:1, 2020:1, 2021:0, 2022:1, 2023:1, 2024:1, 2025:1). Ownership discipline (explained, not silently double-owned): caste-and-village stems (Gandhi versus Ambedkar on the village) are routed to Caste Discrimination; gender-as-capability and empowerment stems to Gender Discrimination; abstract justice, equality and liberty framing to Social and Political Ideals; ideology-label stems (Marxism, socialism as doctrines) to Political Ideologies; universal-dignity and cultural-plurality stems to Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism; and environmental policy, targets, data and named projects to the Environment and Governance areas. Only the six development-concept, human/social development, capability, technology-and-ethics, skill-education, Gandhian-development and tribal-reconciliation parts above are counted here.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2019 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: Does technological development lead to progress in the ethical standards of the society? Explain.

Model solution

Directive: *Explain* - expound the relation, distinguishing carefully, and reach a reasoned position (not a mere list).

Thesis. Technological development expands human *power and capacity*; it does not, on its own, raise the *ethical standards* of society. It changes the ethical terrain and can serve progress only when governed by defensible ends and institutions.

Distinction that fixes the answer. "Progress in ethical standards" is a **normative** improvement in how people treat one another; technological development is a **factual** increase in capability. Reading the second straight off the first is the fact/value slide: more capacity is not more morality.

The two-sided argument.

- *Apparent yes:* technology reduces drudgery, disease and distance, widening what people can be and do (a capability gain), and can enable moral goods - communication, access, relief.
- *Why that does not settle it:* the same power creates **new ethical problems that did not exist before** - surveillance and loss of privacy, algorithmic manipulation, labour displacement, a digital divide that excludes, and ecological cost. Technology is **not self-justifying**: whether its power becomes progress depends on the *ends* it serves and the *institutions* that govern it.

Objection and reply. *Objection:* historically, technological societies show expanded rights and welfare, so technology and ethical progress rise together. *Reply/residual:* correlation is not authorship - where ethical standards rose, it was through **institutions, movements and reasoning** that directed technological power, not through the technology as such; the same period also produced new, technologically enabled harms.

Graded verdict. Technological development is **ethically ambivalent**: it multiplies power and reshapes the moral landscape, but ethical progress is a separate, value-level achievement secured by ends and institutions. Hence technology can *enable* ethical progress but neither guarantees nor constitutes it.

Why this earns marks: it refuses the one-sided "yes", names the fact/value gap explicitly, gives concrete new-harm categories, handles the correlation objection, and closes with a graded verdict rather than a slogan.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2020 Q2(a), 20 marks

Question: State and examine the Gandhian concept of social development.

Model solution

Directive: *State and examine* - first expound the Gandhian concept faithfully, then weigh it with objections and replies and a reasoned verdict.

State - the Gandhian concept of social development. For Gandhi, development is the moral growth of persons and communities, not the volume of production. Its hub is **sarvodaya** - the welfare of all, tested by the condition of the *last and weakest* person. Its supporting commitments are **swaraj** (self-rule as both political freedom and moral self-mastery over wants), **trusteeship** (surplus wealth held in trust for society, not as absolute private right), **restraint of wants** ("enough for need, not for greed"), **dignity of labour** (manual work honoured), and a **decentralised, village-centred** economy using **appropriate technology** scaled to human need. Underlying all is **means-ends unity**: a good end cannot be reached by exploitative means.

Examine - strengths. The model is a powerful critique of consumerist, centralised development: it anticipates **ecological limits** (restraint of throughput), defends **dignity and non-exploitation** as internal to development, and treats people as **moral agents**, not consumers - close, in effect, to a capability-and-sufficiency ethic.

Examine - objections and replies.

- *Scale/romanticisation*: a low-throughput village model may not meet the needs of a large, poor population. *Reply*: the target is insatiable consumerism and centralisation, not health and schooling; "appropriate" scale is revisable without surrendering restraint.
- *Productivity*: restraint may cap the surplus needed to lift millions. *Reply*: the model reframes the *goal* (sufficiency + dignity) rather than maximising output; it is a critique of the metric, not a vow of poverty.
- *Caste and gender (Ambedkar)*: idealising the village can **reproduce caste hierarchy and gendered labour**. This is the decisive internal-Indian criticism, and it is not fully answered within the Gandhian frame.

Graded verdict. Gandhian social development is a **profound critique of output-centred, centralised modernisation and a partial positive model** - ecologically and morally ahead of its rivals - but it must be **corrected by Ambedkar on caste and gender** and made honest about scale. Its enduring contribution is the metric: development measured by dignity, restraint and the condition of the last person.

Why this earns marks: it "states" the concept completely (all five commitments + means-ends unity), "examines" with a genuine objection/reply set, concedes the Ambedkar critique honestly, and delivers a balanced, non-hagiographic verdict.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2022 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Do you agree that economic development does not on its own lead to human development and social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Model solution

Directive: *Do you agree... Give reasons and justifications* - take a defended position, argue both sides, and justify a graded conclusion.

Thesis. I largely agree: **economic development does not, on its own, lead to human development and social progress.** It is at most a *necessary enabler*; whether it becomes human development and progress depends on **conversion, distribution, agency and ecological limits.**

The ladder that grounds the claim. Distinguish **growth** (more output/income), **development** (structural + human change), and **social progress** (a *justified*, value-level improvement). Economic development sits on the lower rungs; human development (capabilities) and progress (normative) are higher rungs that the lower does not guarantee.

Reasons economic development alone is insufficient.

- *Distribution gap:* aggregate income can rise while inequality, exclusion and displacement rise with it - averages hide who gains.
- *Conversion gap (Sen):* the same income yields different real freedoms depending on **conversion factors** (disability, gender norms, environment); income is a means, capability is the measure.
- *Recognition:* redistribution of goods can leave **status hierarchies** (caste, gender, disability) intact - progress needs recognition too.
- *Agency and democracy:* development that treats people as beneficiaries but not **agents** misses a constitutive part of a developed life.
- *Ecological limit:* growth that offloads costs onto the future or the poor is not progress (the sustainability/justice frame).

Justification via the necessary/sufficient point. Some material base is plausibly a **necessary enabling condition** for broad capabilities - so economic development is not worthless. But it is **not sufficient:** it must be *converted*, *distributed* and *bounded* to count as human development and progress.

Objection and reply. *Objection:* no society achieved broad progress without economic development, so the two go together. *Reply/residual:* that shows economic development is an **enabler**, not that it is the *cause* - the enabling base still has to be converted by just institutions and agency; where it was not, growth coexisted with deprivation.

Graded verdict. Agree, with precision: economic development is a **necessary-enabling but not sufficient** condition; it becomes human development and social progress only through **just conversion into capabilities, recognition, democratic agency and ecological limits.**

Why this earns marks: it takes a clear stance, uses the ladder + capability map + recognition + democracy + ecology as *reasons*, answers the strongest counter (co-occurrence), and lands a qualified, defended verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2023 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: In the present scenario, will the emphasis on skill education enhance development? Evaluate.

Model solution

Directive: *Evaluate* - weigh both sides on stated criteria and reach a graded judgement; do not merely describe skill education.

Thesis. Emphasis on skill education **enhances development conditionally** - when skills expand real capabilities and agency, not merely labour-market employability. As a stand-alone metric, skilling is a *partial* good that can leave people capable yet unfree.

The case for skill education. Skills raise **employability and productivity**, and income can convert (Sen) into further capabilities - health, schooling, security. In a young population, skilling can widen what people are able to do and reduce dependence, which is a genuine developmental gain.

The evaluative limits.

- *Employability is not capability*: training aimed only at market demand can produce **capable workers who remain unfree** - precarious work, no voice, no recognition.
- *Distribution*: if skilling tracks existing advantage, it can **widen** gaps rather than close them.
- *Agency and dignity*: development also requires participation and dignity of labour, which pure skilling does not supply.
- *Quality and match*: skills that do not match real opportunities yield frustration, not freedom.

Objection and reply. *Objection*: in a labour-surplus economy, skilling is the most practical lever of development, so the emphasis is justified. *Reply/residual*: practical value is conceded, but the *emphasis* must be evaluated against the fuller aim - skilling enhances development **only if** it is coupled with capability expansion, decent work and agency; otherwise it enhances output while under-delivering on development.

Graded verdict. Skill education **enhances development when it is capability-directed** - broad, dignified, well-matched and paired with voice and decent work - and under-delivers when reduced to market throughput. The emphasis is justified *conditionally*, not unconditionally.

Why this earns marks: it "evaluates" (two-sided, criterion-based), deploys the employability-vs-capability distinction, answers the practicality objection, and gives a conditional graded verdict rather than a yes/no.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2024 Q3(c), 10+5=15 marks

Question: Is economic development a necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither, in order to achieve social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Model solution

Directive: *necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither...* Give reasons and justifications - a precise modal analysis plus a defended verdict (the 10+5 split rewards clean analysis, then judgement).

Thesis. Economic development is, at most, a **necessary enabling condition** for social progress - and **not a sufficient** one. Strictly, it is **neither necessary in every case nor ever sufficient**; the accurate answer is "a necessary-enabler at most, never sufficient."

Fix the modal terms. *Necessary:* progress cannot occur without it. *Sufficient:* its presence guarantees progress. The question forces us to test economic development against both.

Is it necessary? Qualified yes (the material-threshold nuance). Core capabilities - health, education, security - need **some** resource base, so a degree of economic development is plausibly a **necessary enabling condition** for *broad* social progress. *But* limited progress on specific axes (recognition, dignity, participation, legal equality) can be won through **redistribution and reform** without much growth - so economic development is **not strictly necessary in every case**.

Is it sufficient? No. Growth can coexist with **inequality, exclusion, displacement, ecological damage and lost agency**. Averages hide distribution; income must be **converted** (Sen: conversion factors) into real freedoms and **recognised** (status justice) to count as progress. Therefore economic development can never, by itself, secure social progress.

Reasons and justification (the 5-mark judgement).

- *Distribution + conversion:* same output, different real freedoms - so presence of growth does not entail progress.
- *Recognition + agency:* material gain leaves status hierarchies and voicelessness untouched unless institutions act.
- *Ecological limit:* growth that steals from the future or the poor is not progress.
- *Counter-case:* reform-driven gains without growth show non-necessity in specific domains.

Graded verdict. Neither strictly necessary in every case nor ever sufficient - economic development is best classified as a **necessary-enabling condition at most**, which becomes social progress only through **just conversion into capabilities, recognition, democratic agency and ecological limits**.

Why this earns marks: it defines the modal terms, answers *both* necessity and sufficiency with the material-threshold and counter-case nuance (not a flat "necessary but not sufficient"), justifies with distribution/conversion/recognition/ecology, and closes with the precise "neither... at most enabling" verdict the 10+5 split rewards.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2025 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: Is it possible to reconcile the concept of development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress? Discuss.

Model solution

Directive: *Is it possible... Discuss* - argue possibility conditionally, staging both the sceptical and affirmative cases, and specify the conditions.

Thesis. Reconciling development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress is **possible, but only conditionally** - when development shifts from *extraction* to *capability expansion under shared decision-power*, passing four tests. Absent those conditions, "development" is displacement mislabelled.

Frame the conflict. Projects called "development" can impose **displacement, extraction, ecological loss and cultural assimilation** on tribal communities while benefits flow elsewhere. The values at stake are not "backwardness" but **community, ecology, self-governance and a distinct conception of a good life** - so the clash is between two *models* of development, not between development and its absence.

The reconciliation model - four tests.

- **Capability test:** count capabilities *destroyed* (land, forest, community, culture) alongside those *created* (income, schooling) - a net-capability view.
- **Participation test:** tribal communities must share in the **decision**, not merely receive compensation afterwards - agency, not transfer.
- **Irreversibility test:** where loss is permanent (sacred landscape, ecosystem, language), apply a **precautionary presumption against** the project (strong-sustainability logic).
- **Burden test:** costs must not be shifted onto the **least able** while benefits accrue to the advantaged.

Indian legal recognition (facts, not proof). That such reconciliation is institutionally conceivable is shown by **PESA 1996** and the **Forest Rights Act 2006** (statutes recognising Gram Sabha powers and forest rights), *Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest (2013)*, Gram Sabha consideration in the Niyamgiri context), and **Articles 48A and 51A(g)** (non-justiciable environmental provisions). These are **legal facts** of recognition; they do not by themselves prove the philosophical thesis, but they show the reconciliation is not merely utopian.

Objection and reply. *Objection (both ways):* either tribal values are an obstacle to progress (steamroll), or all development is imposition (romanticise). *Reply/residual:* both are errors - tribal communities also demand capabilities (health, schooling), and genuine consent can license development; the disciplined position denies neither their agency nor their needs, and makes **decision-power**, not compensation, the hinge.

Graded verdict. Reconciliation is **possible if and only if** the four tests are met and consent is real - development as *capability expansion, chosen by the community, within ecological limits*. Then it brings social and economic progress together; otherwise it is extraction renamed.

Why this earns marks: it answers "is it possible" with a conditional thesis, supplies a concrete four-test engine, uses the Indian statutes/judgment/Articles correctly as *facts* (not proof), refuses both romanticising and steamrolling, and specifies the exact conditions in the verdict.

Three original questions authored for this package (not PYQs), one each at 10, 15 and 20 marks, with full model solutions.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains 1

Original question (not a PYQ) - Philosophy Paper II, Socio-Political Philosophy | 10 marks | ~150 words | directive: Distinguish + Explain.

Question: Distinguish between economic growth, development and social progress, and explain why the distinction matters for policy. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The three are distinct levels - a quantitative means, a structural change, and a defended value - and collapsing them distorts policy.

Distinctions.

- **Economic growth:** a rise in aggregate output/income; a *possible means*, silent on distribution and cost.
- **Development:** structural and human change - capabilities, health, education, institutions; descriptive but richer than output.
- **Social progress:** an *evaluative* judgement that a change is good and fairly shared, made on a stated criterion (freedom, justice, dignity, sustainability).

Why it matters for policy. If growth is mistaken for progress (the economistic category slide), policy targets averages while inequality, displacement and ecological cost worsen. Keeping the rungs separate forces policy to ask not only 'how much more?' but 'converted into whose capabilities, under what justice and within what limits?'

Verdict. Growth can *finance* development, but only capabilities, justice, participation and ecological limits convert material change into social progress.

Why this earns marks: three clean definitions, the category-slide point, and a policy pay-off with a crisp verdict.

Original Mains 2

Original question (not a PYQ) - Philosophy Paper II, Socio-Political Philosophy | 15 marks | ~220 words | directive: Examine.

Question: The capability approach shifts the question of development from 'how many resources does a person command?' to 'what is a person actually able to be and to do?'. Examine this shift and its limits. Answer in about 220 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The capability shift is the decisive advance in development theory, but its measurement burden and specification dispute mark its limits.

The shift. Sen replaces resources and utility with **real freedom**. A *functioning* is an achieved being/doing; a *capability* is the freedom to achieve functionings; *agency* is being the author of one's ends. **Conversion factors** explain why equal resources yield unequal freedom (disability, gender norms, environment), and **adaptive preferences** show that expressed satisfaction can mask deprivation. Mahbub ul Haq and the UNDP framework translate this into human development.

What it buys. It reclassifies the field: resources are means, utility is an unreliable mental state, achieved functionings are outcomes, capabilities are real opportunities. Development becomes the expansion of what people can be and do, with people as agents, not mere beneficiaries.

Limits.

- **Measurement:** capabilities are harder to quantify than income, so indices (HDI) are useful but partial proxies - never mistake the index for the thing.
- **Specification (Sen vs Nussbaum):** Sen leaves the list open to public reasoning (pluralism, but underspecification); Nussbaum defends a threshold list (sharper, but risks paternalism).

Verdict. The shift is correct and largely settled; the open questions are *how to measure* and *how far to specify* capabilities - not whether to make the shift.

Why this earns marks: it examines both the gain and the two genuine limits, names the internal debate precisely, and reaches a qualified verdict.

Original Mains 3

Original question (not a PYQ) - Philosophy Paper II, Socio-Political Philosophy | 20 marks | ~300 words | directive: Critically examine + Assess.

Question: Critically examine the view that development is legitimate only within ecological limits and intergenerational justice, and assess whether a 'degrowth' prescription is appropriate for a country with large unmet basic needs. Answer in about 300 words.

Model solution

Thesis. Bounding development by ecological limits and intergenerational justice is defensible; a *blanket* degrowth prescription is not appropriate for a society with large unmet basic needs, which requires capability expansion at the base coupled with sufficiency at the top.

The case for limits. The sustainability/justice triangle has three corners: **ecological limit** (finite throughput; under *strong* sustainability some natural functions are non-substitutable), **intergenerational justice** (duties to future people), and **distributive justice now** (the environmentalism of the poor - who bears ecological costs today). The **non-identity problem** shows our choices determine which future people exist, so obligation shifts from person-affecting harm to **impersonal duties and precaution**. Naess's (1973) deep ecology and the anthropocentric/biocentric/ecocentric spectrum widen moral standing. The 'development versus environment' framing is a **false dichotomy**: the real question is which development, distributed how, within what limits.

Assessing degrowth. Degrowth rightly attacks **productivism** (output as the goal). But applied wholesale to a country with large unmet needs, it is **asymmetric**: it would cap the base-level capability expansion (health, schooling, security) that the poor legitimately demand. The disciplined position couples **sufficiency at the top** (restraint of luxury throughput) with **capability expansion at the base**, all under ecological limits.

Objection and reply. *Objection:* ecological emergency justifies suspending growth and even democracy (eco-authoritarianism). *Reply/residual:* this trades away agency, a constitutive part of development; the answer is a **just transition** - limits met *with* participation and distributive fairness, protecting the vulnerable.

Verdict. Development ought to be bounded by ecological limits and intergenerational justice; but the instrument is a *just transition with base-level capability expansion*, not blanket degrowth. (Articles 48A and 51A(g) are non-justiciable facts of constitutional concern, not proof of any thesis.)

Why this earns marks: it critically examines the limits thesis, assesses degrowth with the India-specific asymmetry, answers the eco-authoritarian objection, and closes with a calibrated verdict and correct legal-status discipline.

Answer-specific execution and compression upgrades

These controls follow the detailed models and make each one executable in the timed paper.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2019 Q2(c), 15 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Does**. Address this exact question: *Does technological development lead to progress in the ethical standards of the society? Explain.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Does technological development lead to progress in the ethical standards of the society? Explain.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2020 Q2(a), 20 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **State**. Address this exact question: *State and examine the Gandhian concept of social development.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *State and examine the Gandhian concept of social development.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: about 300 words: thesis, six developed moves, named comparison, strongest objection/reply, India-linked application where relevant and a graded conclusion. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2022 Q3(a), 20 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *Do you agree that economic development does not on its own lead to human development and social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Do you agree that economic development does not on its own lead to human development and social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: about 300 words: thesis, six developed moves, named comparison, strongest objection/reply, India-linked application where relevant and a graded conclusion. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2023 Q2(c), 15 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *In the present scenario, will the emphasis on skill education enhance development? Evaluate*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *In the present scenario, will the emphasis on skill education enhance development? Evaluate*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2024 Q3(c), 10+5=15 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Is**. Address this exact question: *Is economic development a necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither, in order to achieve social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Is economic development a necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither, in order to achieve social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2025 Q3(c), 15 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Is**. Address this exact question: *Is it possible to reconcile the concept of development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress? Discuss*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Is it possible to reconcile the concept of development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress? Discuss*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Original Mains 1 - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Distinguish**. Address this exact question: *Distinguish between economic growth, development and social progress, and explain why the distinction matters for policy. Answer in about 150 words.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Distinguish between economic growth, development and social progress, and explain why the distinction matters for policy. Answer in about 150 words.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Original Mains 2 - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *The capability approach shifts the question of development from 'how many resources does a person command?' to 'what is a person actually able to be and to do?'. Examine this shift and its limits. Answer in about 220 words.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *The capability approach shifts the question of development from 'how many resources does a person command?' to 'what is a person actually able to be and to do?'. Examine this shift and its limits. Answer in about 220 words.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Original Mains 3 - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Critically examine**. Address this exact question: *Critically examine the view that development is legitimate only within ecological limits and intergenerational justice, and assess whether a 'degrowth' prescription is appropriate for a country with large unmet basic needs. Answer in about 300 words.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Critically examine the view that development is legitimate only within ecological limits and intergenerational justice, and assess whether a 'degrowth' prescription is appropriate for a country with large unmet basic needs. Answer in about 300 words.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.